



ZEN

Brand & Product Design System

A quiet rhythm for daily practice.

Design direction · July 2026

Meditation should end more gently than an alarm.

Zen removes friction around starting, finishing, and returning to a regular practice.

THE PROBLEM

Abrupt by default

Phone alarms are useful but abrasive. They pull attention back too sharply and make the timer feel separate from the practice.

THE EXPERIENCE

Quiet from start to finish

Choose a duration, begin, and sit. Zen stays silent until a soft completion signal brings the session to a close.

THE HABIT

Encouragement without pressure

Gentle reminders and restrained progress views support consistency without turning meditation into a performance metric.

Presence without pressure.

A brand that feels composed, warm, and quietly confident.

Calm	_____	never sleepy
Thoughtful	_____	never precious
Warm	_____	never sentimental
Confident	_____	never demanding
Minimal	_____	never empty

PRODUCT PROMISE

Support the practice
without becoming the
focus of it.

Invite. Reassure. Acknowledge effort without
judgement.

An open circle for an ongoing practice.

The ensō is complete enough to hold the moment and open enough to begin again.



App icon

Ink on Mist • no container effects

PRESERVE	brush texture and the open right edge
CLEAR SPACE	one quarter of the symbol diameter
PRIMARY	Ink on Mist
INVERSE	Mist on Ink
NEVER	rotate, redraw, outline, or decorate

Warm neutrals. One living accent.

Tonal separation does most of the work; Moss appears only where attention or affirmation matters.



LIGHT

Mist canvas • Paper surfaces • Ink text • Moss selection

DARK

Ink canvas • Slate surfaces • Mist text • softened Moss

Editorial warmth, product clarity.

Serif carries reflective moments; sans-serif carries every task and label.

Iowan Old Style

A quiet rhythm

Canela where licensed • display, emotional headlines, session time

Inter

Begin your practice

Söhne where licensed • body, labels, navigation, data

48 / 52

Display

36 / 42

Heading

16 / 24

Body text

Use tabular numerals for timers, streaks, durations, and charts.

Space is part of the interaction.

A quiet screen has one focal point, generous breathing room, and a primary action within reach.

RHYTHM

8-point foundation

24 pt phone gutters
32 pt major sections
44 × 44 pt minimum targets
One clear focal point

SHAPE

Soft, not playful

8 pt small radius
12 pt controls
20 pt cards
28 pt modals
Full pills for actions

DEPTH

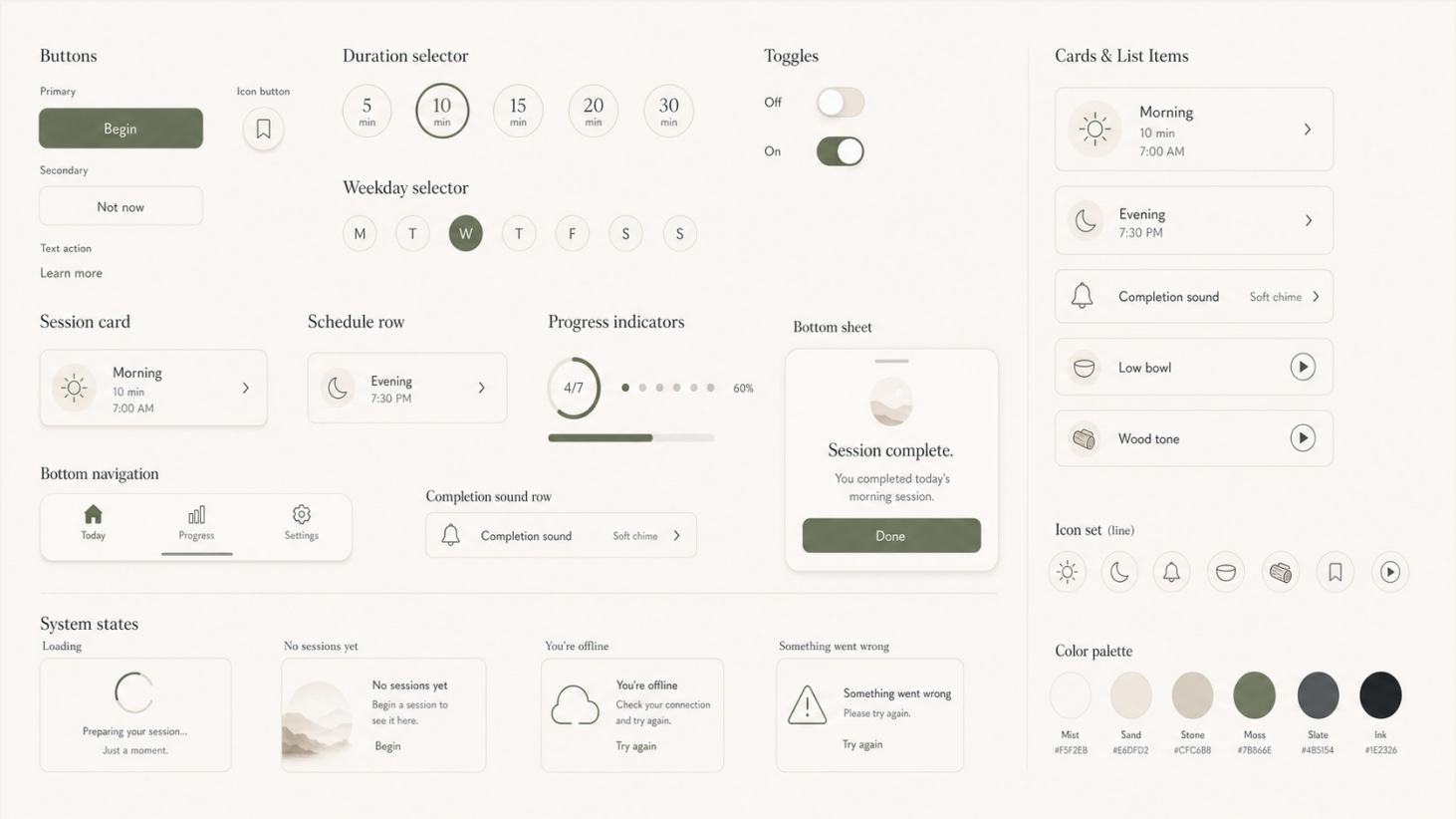
Tonal before shadow

Warm surface changes first.
One-pixel quiet borders.
Broad, soft shadows only when hierarchy needs them.

The design should feel composed before it feels decorated.

A small system with deliberate states.

Buttons, selectors, cards, progress, navigation, sheets, and system states share one restrained visual grammar.



Motion should feel like breath, never spectacle.

Silence is the default. The ending is soft, brief, and unmistakably non-alarming.

120 ms	Tap response	Immediate, quiet confirmation
240 ms	Screen transition	Gentle ease-out on entry
240–450 ms	Cards and sheets	Enough time to settle, never float
2.4–3.2 s	Breathing field	Subtle loop; removed with reduced motion

SESSION AUDIO

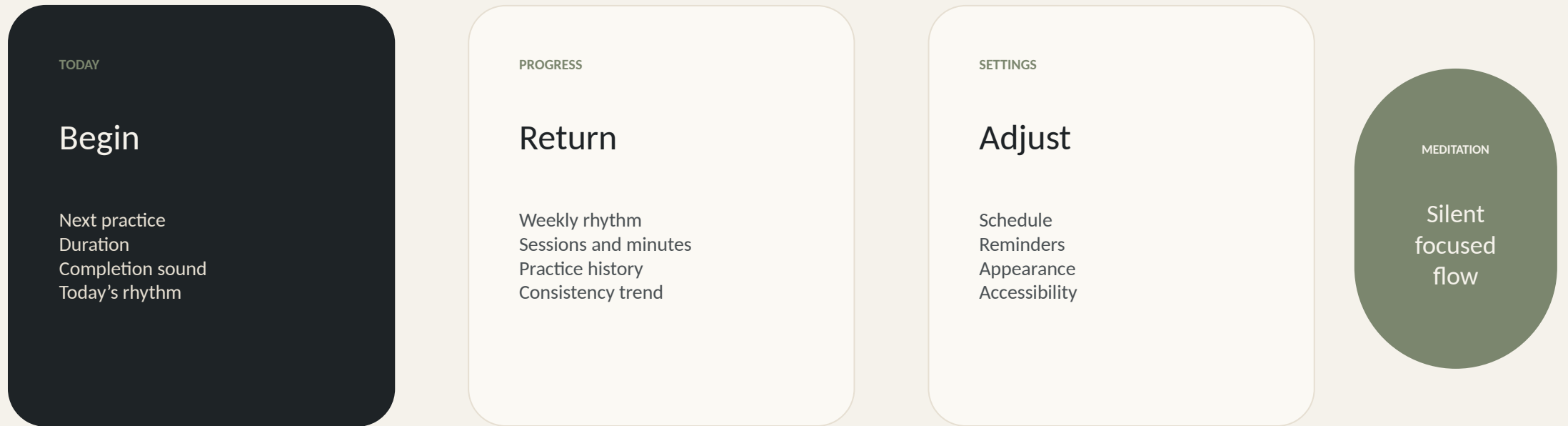
Silent until completion.

No alarm patterns.
No repeated alert.
No sharp attack.

Optional haptics: start • pause • complete

One practice, three destinations.

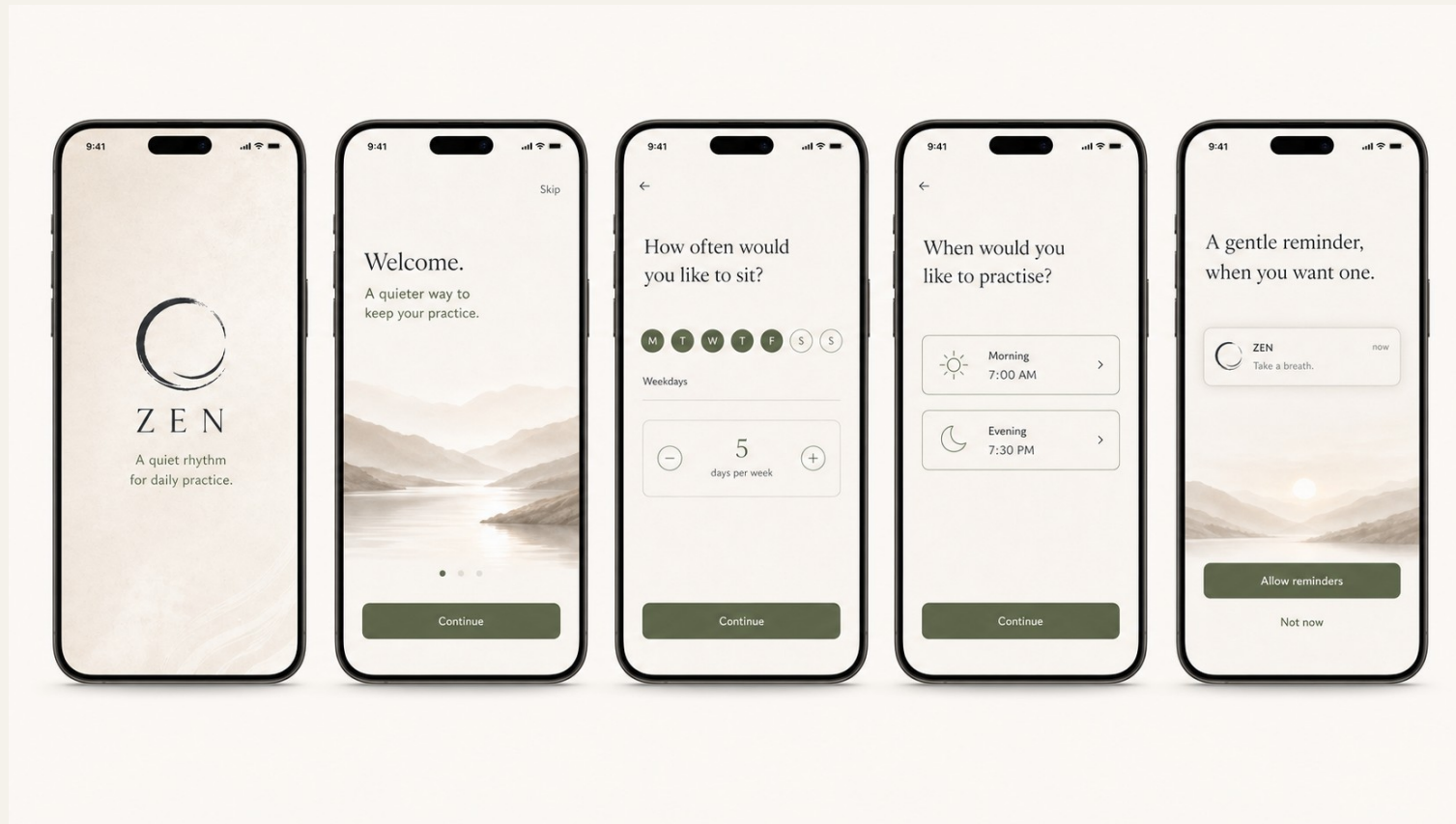
Meditation runs as a focused layer above the primary navigation.



Not a content library. Not guided meditation. No account required for the initial product.

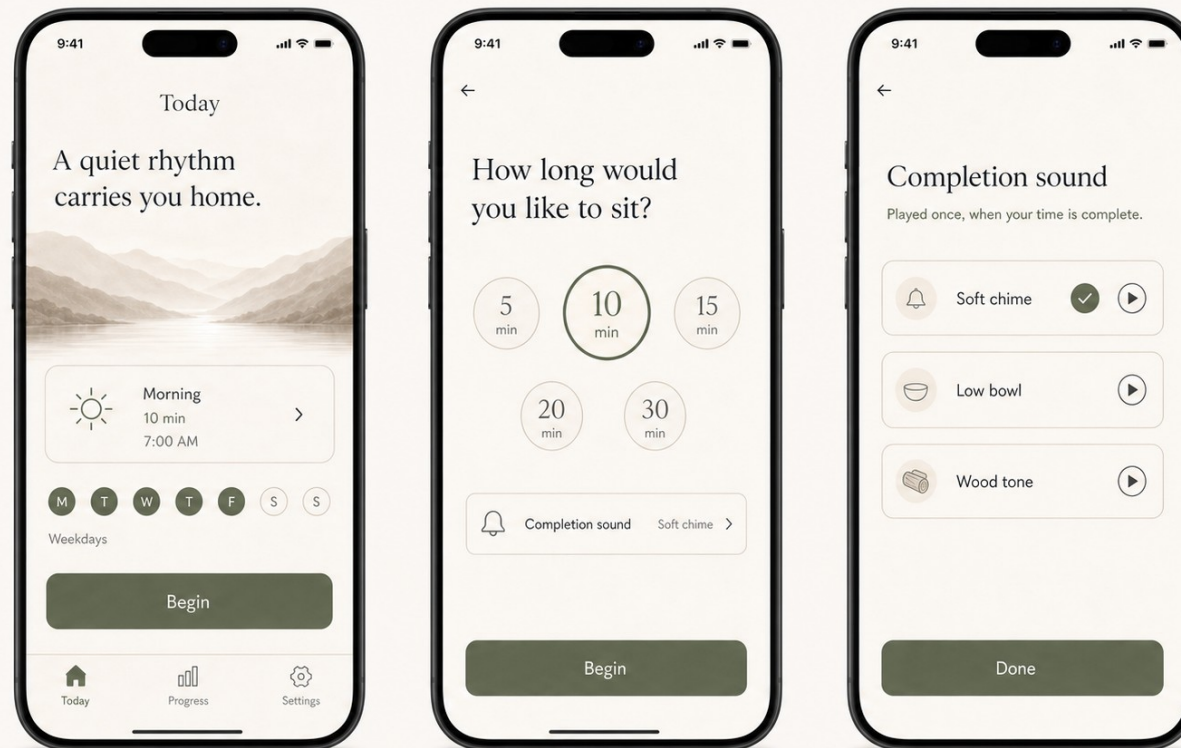
Onboarding sets an intention, not a target.

Five surfaces introduce Zen, capture a flexible cadence, offer practice times, and ask gently for reminder permission.



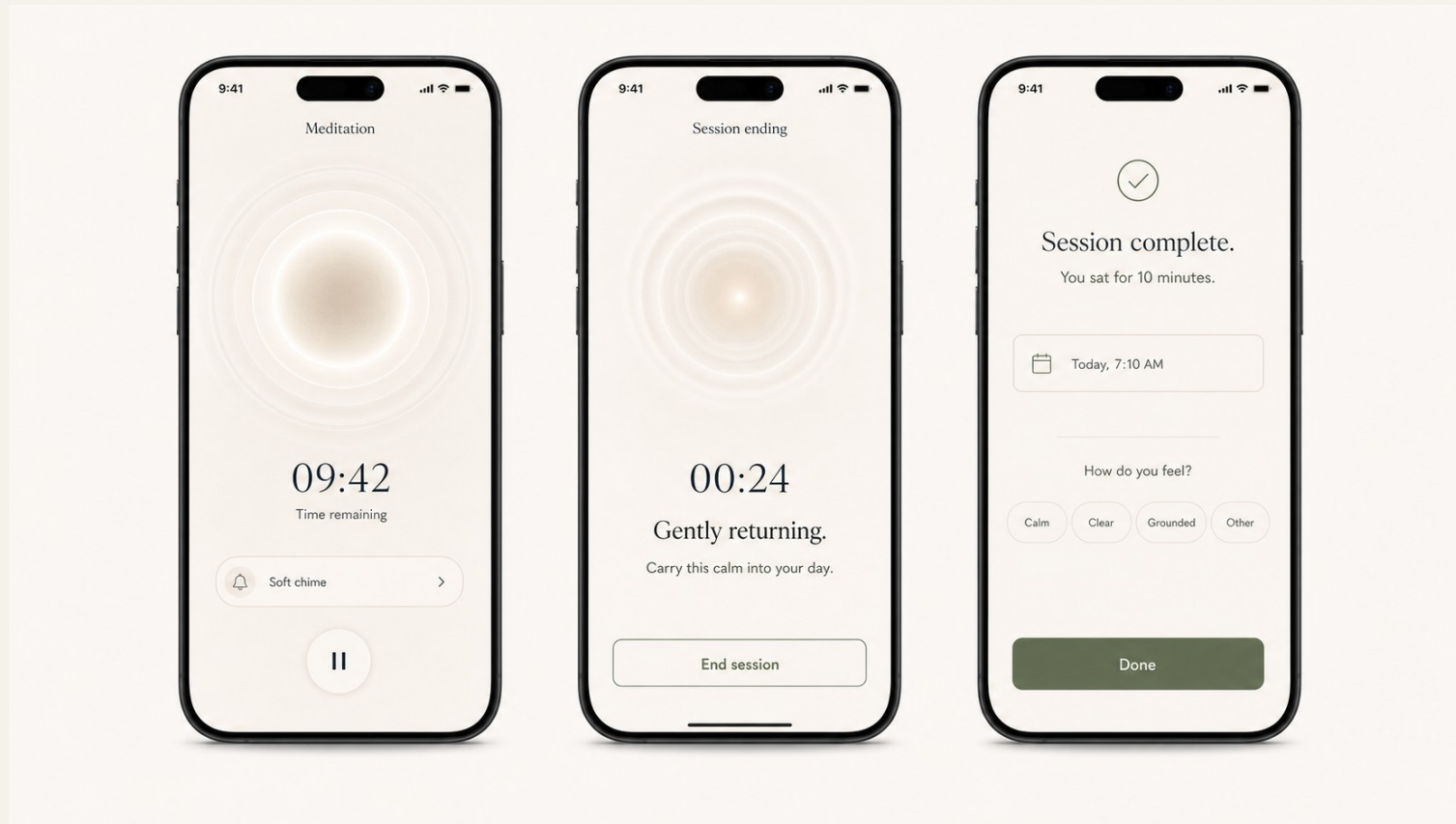
Today is intentionally small.

The next planned practice, duration, and completion sound are all that stand between opening Zen and beginning.



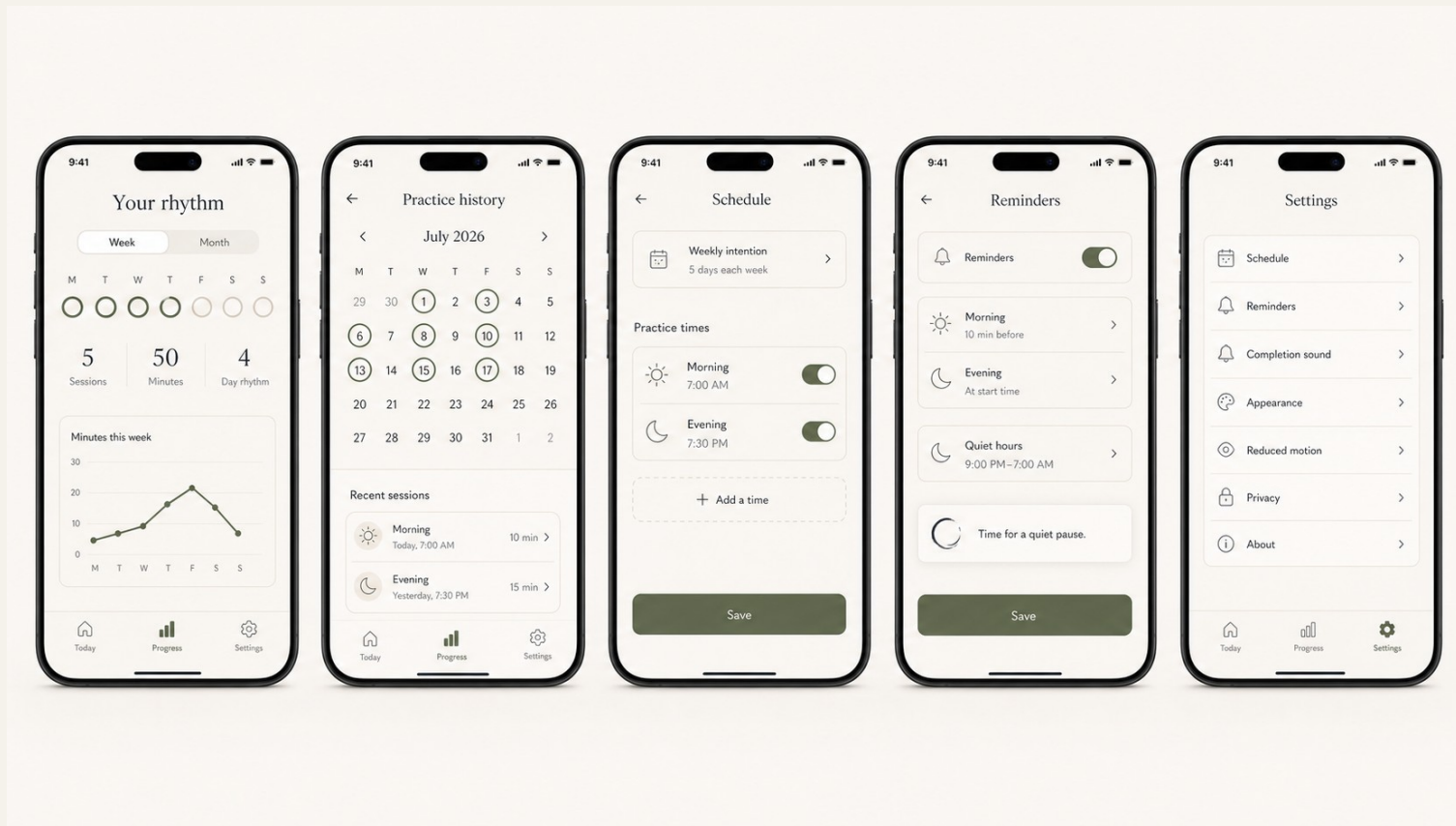
The timer recedes while the practice takes over.

Active, ending, and complete states preserve focus and return attention gradually.



Progress makes return feel inviting.

Rhythm, history, schedules, reminders, and preferences are visible without turning a missed day into failure.



Quiet does not mean ambiguous.

Zen remains clear, reachable, and fully usable without sound or motion.

ACCESS

Readable by default

WCAG AA contrast
16 pt default body
Dynamic Type support
44 × 44 pt targets
Labels expose state

ADAPT

Respect preferences

Reduced-motion fades
No colour-only meaning
Silent completion remains usable
Haptics are optional
System reminders stay optional

VOICE

Invite, never command

Short direct sentences.
No urgency.
No productivity language.
No spiritual clichés.
No exaggerated praise.

EXAMPLE

“Your practice is ready when you are.”

Build the feeling, not just the screens.

The source of truth lives in docs/design:

BRAND.md

SCREENS.md

tokens.json

screens/

assets/

ZEN

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